1 An introduction to D3.js

This chapter covers

- The basics of HTML, CSS, and the Document Object Model (DOM)
- The principles of Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG)
- Data-binding and selections with D3
- Different data types and their data visualization methods

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D3 stands for *data-driven documents*. It's a brand name, but also a class of applications that have been offered on the web in one form or another for years. For quite some time we've been building and working with data-driven documents such as interactive dashboards, rich internet applications, and dynamically driven content. In one sense, the D3.js library is an iterative step in a chain of technologies used for data-driven documents, but in another sense, it's a radical step.